

August: An easy-to-use computer

The Bendix G-15 computer was introduced by the Bendix Corporation. It was easy to use; the operator did not need special training. It was also comparatively cheaper (you could get a G-15 for \$60,000 (Rs 3.2 crore now) or rent out one for about \$1,500 (Rs 8 lakh now) per month). This enabled smaller companies to use the system. The G-15's dimensions were 5 x 3 x 3 feet and it weighed 450 kg. The system was built mainly for scientific and industrial users.

September: Disk storage

The IBM 305 RAMAC (Random Access Method of Accounting and Control), the first computer to use magnetic disk drives for secondary storage instead of electrostatic tubes or magnetic drums was introduced. It was also one of the last vacuum tube computers; later models would be solid-state. The capacity of the 305 was 5 million characters, which were stored on 50 24-inch aluminium disks coated with magnetic iron oxide. The disks ran at 1,200



A platter of the IBM 305 RAMAC's hard disk

Tech In Sport

The 305 RAMAC was used in the 1960 Winter Olympics to handle the first electronic data processing system

rpm, and the distance between the read head and the disk surface was 800 micro-inches (modern drives have a distance of less than 3 micro-inches). The system was available for \$160,000 (Rs 8.6 crore now) though buyers had the option of leasing it for \$3,200 (Rs 17 lakh now) per month. About 1,000 systems were built before production ended in 1961.